ISSUE
No
XIII

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026
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ISSUE
No
XIII

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

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No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.

-SARAH J. MAAS

STAY INFORMED. STAT AHEAD. SUCCED.

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THE HINDU · GENDER RIGHTS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW

Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights

> *Kerala's progressive ethos must firmly resist religious dictates curbing Muslim women's public participation.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar's directive to restrict Muslim women's participation in public celebrations has **unsettled**[2] Keralam because it **strikes at**[3] a fundamental question: women's right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad's 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can **intrude into**[4] the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such **departures**[5]. That argument **holds no weight**[6]. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to **conform to**[7] the values **enshrined in**[8] the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause "chaos", the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is **at variance with**[9] constitutional equality and Keralam's long struggle to expand the space in public life for women **disadvantaged**[10] by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a **monolith**[11]. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a **counter-current**[12] of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam's main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely **guarded**[13] until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan **rubbished**[14] the **decree**[15] as **antediluvian**[16]. The Indian Union Muslim League's silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women's forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot **equivocate**[17] when women's right to public participation is **open to challenge**[18]. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, Vande Mataram and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not **confer on**[19] religious authorities the right to regulate women's freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were **awash with**[20] videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram's remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while **making exceptions for**[21] orthodoxy.

Source: The Hindu · Published: September 03, 2026 12:20 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

No.	Word	Part of speech	Meaning
1	Redux	(Adjective)	revived • पुनरुत्थान या वापसी
2	Unsettled	(Verb)	disturbed • अशांत कर दिया
3	Strikes at	(Verb)	attacks • पर गहरा प्रहार करना
4	Intrude into	(Verb)	interfere in • अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना
5	Departures	(Noun)	deviations • परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव
6	Holds no weight	(Phrase)	lacks validity • तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना
7	Conform to	(Verb)	follow • के अनुसार होना या पालन करना
8	Enshrined in	(Verb)	protected in • पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित
9	At variance with	(Phrase)	in conflict with • के विपरीत या असंगत
10	Disadvantaged	(Adjective)	underprivileged • वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ
11	Monolith	(Noun)	single entity • एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह
12	Counter-current	(Noun)	opposing trend • विपरीत धारा
13	Guarded	(Adjective)	cautious • सतर्क या संकोची
14	Rubbished	(Verb)	rejected strongly • पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना
15	Decree	(Noun)	official order • आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान
16	Antediluvian	(Adjective)	primitive • अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी
17	Equivocate	(Verb)	dodge the truth • गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना
18	Open to challenge	(Phrase)	vulnerable to dispute • विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना
19	Confer on	(Verb)	grant to • प्रदान करना या सौंपना
20	Awash with	(Adjective)	full of • से सराबोर या भरा हुआ
21	Making exceptions for	(Phrase)	exempting • के लिए विशेष छूट देना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights
THE HINDU · GENDER RIGHTS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW

EDITORIAL STANCE
DISAPPROVING
"strongly objecting to orthodoxy"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author takes a firm stance against regressive clerical directives aimed at curtailing Muslim women's presence in public spaces. By invoking constitutional principles and Kerala's reformist heritage, the editorial condemns political equivocation and asserts that religious autonomy cannot override fundamental gender equality.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 8 WORDS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Unsettled** VERB NEGATIVE	अशांत कर दिया Caused someone or a society to feel anxious, disturbed, or unstable.	Un + settled: losing one's settled peace of mind or calm stability.	disconcerted perturbed agitated	composed reassured pacified
02	**Departures** NOUN NEUTRAL	परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव Divergences or variations from established rules, customs, or accepted norms.	When a train departs, it leaves the platform; when an action is a departure, it leaves standard custom.	deviations divergences aberrations	conformities adherences continuations
03	**Disadvantaged** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ Placed in an unfavourable or deprived position regarding social rights and opportunities.	Dis (not) + advantaged: denied the basic opportunities and benefits enjoyed by others.	marginalised deprived underprivileged	privileged advantaged empowered
04	**Counter-current** NOUN NEGATIVE	विपरीत धारा A trend or tendency running contrary to the predominant movement or prevailing progress.	A current flowing in the counter (opposite) direction against the main tide.	backlash counteraction reversal	mainstream momentum concurrence
05	**Guarded** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सतर्क या संकोची Careful, restrained, and unwilling to reveal true opinions or commit firmly.	Keeping your guard up so you don't reveal too much or make commitments.	circumspect non-committal reticent	forthright candid unreserved
06	**Rubbished** VERB NEGATIVE	पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना Criticised, ridiculed, or rejected an idea as completely absurd or worthless.	Treating someone's idea like 'rubbish' (trash) by throwing it out with contempt.	dismissed derided repudiated	endorsed lauded validated
07	**Decree** NOUN NEUTRAL	आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान An authoritative order, dictate, or edict having the binding force of law or religious mandate.	Decree rhymes with 'agree'; a command that everyone is ordered to agree with.	edict dictate pronouncement	recommendation suggestion petition
08	**Equivocate** VERB NEGATIVE	गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना To use ambiguous language to conceal the truth or avoid committing oneself to a clear position.	Equi (equal) + vocal (voice): speaking with two equal voices to confuse the listener.	prevaricate temporise vacillate	clarify speak frankly declare openly

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · ORTHODOXY REDUX: ON KERALAM, RELIGION AND MUSLIM WOMEN'S RIGHTS · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 2 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Monolith** NOUN NEUTRAL	एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह A large, uniform, and indivisible organisation or community that lacks internal diversity.	Mono (single) + lith (stone): a single giant stone, metaphorically meaning a uniform, indivisible body.	uniform whole homogeneous mass indivisible entity	heterogeneous group plurality mosaic
02	**Antediluvian** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी Extremely old-fashioned, archaic, or ridiculously out of date.	Ante (before) + deluge (the biblical flood): so extremely old that it belongs before Noah's flood.	archaic outmoded antiquated	modern progressive contemporary

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 5 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Intrude into** VERB NEGATIVE	अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना To enter or force oneself into a private sphere where one is not welcomed or entitled to be.	Intruders enter private spaces without permission; hence 'intrude into' means encroaching unlawfully.	encroach on trespass upon infringe upon	withdraw from disregard leave alone
02	**Conform to** VERB NEUTRAL	के अनुसार होना या पालन करना To comply with rules, standards, laws, or accepted customs.	Conform = comply with the form/standard set by rules.	adhere to abide by align with	deviate from violate flout
03	**Enshrined in** VERB POSITIVE	पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित Preserved, protected, and expressed formally as a cherished right or principle.	Placing something in a 'shrine' preserves it with utmost reverence and permanence.	embodied in entrenched in safeguarded in	excised from erased from omitted from
04	**Confer on** VERB NEUTRAL	प्रदान करना या सौंपना To grant or bestow a title, right, privilege, or power upon someone.	Confer is to offer a right or title upon someone with authority.	bestow upon accord to grant to	divest of withhold from strip from
05	**Awash with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	से सराबोर या भरा हुआ Containing large numbers or quantities of something; completely inundated or flooded.	Awash implies being submerged under high waves of water or content.	inundated with replete with overflowing with	devoid of deficient in lacking in

PHRASAL VERBS · 1 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Strikes at** VERB NEGATIVE	पर गहरा प्रहार करना Directly threatens, challenges, or affects the essential foundation of something.	When you strike at the core, you hit the most essential foundation directly.	undermines assails threatens	fortifies upholds sustains

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 4 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Holds no weight** PHRASE NEGATIVE	तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना Lacks convincing force, credibility, or logical significance.	An argument with zero weight will simply blow away because it has no substance.	carries no conviction lacks merit falls flat	holds water carries weight remains valid
02	**At variance with** PHRASE NEGATIVE	के विपरीत या असंगत In direct contradiction, disagreement, or conflict with something else.	Variance means variation or dispute; if you are 'at variance', you vary completely from the norm.	incompatible with contrary to inconsistent with	in harmony with consistent with in accord with
03	**Open to challenge** PHRASE NEGATIVE	विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना Vulnerable to questioning, opposition, or legal and social contestation.	If a gate is left 'open', anyone can step up and challenge whatever is inside.	disputable contestable vulnerable	indisputable unassailable incontestable
04	**Making exceptions for** PHRASE NEGATIVE	के लिए विशेष छूट देना Allowing a particular person, group, or ideology to be exempt from general rules or progressive standards.	Carving out an 'exception' lets someone bypass the standard rule that applies to all.	granting exemptions to tolerating indulging	applying universally to enforcing strictly against disallowing

FOREIGN WORDS · 1 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Redux** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पुनरुत्थान या वापसी Brought back, revived, or restored, especially an idea or condition from the past.	Sounds like 're-do'; think of something brought back or repeated again.	resurgent revisited returned	extinct vanished obsolete

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Many layers: On onion produce, issues

THE HINDU · AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS / TRADE POLICY

Many layers: On onion produce, issues

> *Reactive market interventions fail to resolve structural flaws in India's agricultural supply chain.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

While the government has **alluded to**[9] some price **manipulation**[10], the **dominant**[11] issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking **proactive**[12] measures, including improving options, maintaining a less **erratic**[4] trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the kharif crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large **buffers**[13], are simply among the pressures that **highlighted**[14] the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu's targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is **commendably**[15] designed to discourage **hoarding**[16] while allowing private retail prices to **cool down**[17]. However, the State must also **guard against**[18] the **pitfalls**[19] of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network — its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more susceptible than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% — and if the need arises to **persist with**[21] the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly **exhausted**[22], more so given this year's high storage losses of around 30%.

Source: The Hindu · Published: September 03, 2026 12:10 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

No.	Word	Part of speech	Meaning
1	balancing-act	(Noun)	compromise • संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास
2	remunerative	(Adjective)	profitable • लाभकारी / फलप्रद
3	volatility	(Noun)	instability • अस्थिरता
4	erratic	(Adjective)	unpredictable • अनियमित / डांवाडोल
5	rendered	(Verb)	made • बना दिया / कर दिया
6	bounteous	(Adjective)	abundant • प्रचुर / भरपूर
7	procurement	(Noun)	purchasing • खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति
8	subsequently	(Adverb)	afterwards • बाद में / तत्पश्चात
9	alluded to	(Verb)	hinted at • का संकेत देना
10	manipulation	(Noun)	rigging • हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़
11	dominant	(Adjective)	primary • प्रमुख / मुख्य
12	proactive	(Adjective)	forward-thinking • सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय
13	buffers	(Noun)	reserves • सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक
14	highlighted	(Verb)	emphasised • उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी
15	commendably	(Adverb)	praiseworthy • सराहनीय रूप से
16	hoarding	(Noun)	stockpiling • जमाखोरी
17	cool down	(Verb)	moderate • शांत या स्थिर होना
18	guard against	(Verb)	prevent • से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना
19	pitfalls	(Noun)	hazards • छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां
20	susceptible to	(Adjective)	vulnerable to • के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील
21	persist with	(Verb)	continue • जारी रखना / लगे रहना
22	exhausted	(Verb)	depleted • समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Many layers: On onion produce, issues
THE HINDU · AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS / TRADE POLICY

EDITORIAL STANCE
CRITICAL
"fault-finding and analytical"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author evaluates India's agricultural trade interventions, arguing that knee-jerk policy shifts fail both farmers and consumers. By highlighting erratic export duties, inadequate storage infrastructure, and recurring price shocks, the text underscores the limits of reactive governance. The author advocates for proactive, structural reforms over temporary subsidies to achieve long-term market stability.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 14 WORDS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**remunerative** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	लाभकारी / फलप्रद Earning or paying a substantial amount of profit or financial reward.	Sound like 're-money-rative' — getting good money/profit in return for work.	lucrative profitable gainful	unremunerative unprofitable loss-making
02	**volatility** NOUN NEGATIVE	अस्थिरता The quality of changing rapidly and unpredictably, especially for the worse.	Volatile chemicals evaporate quickly and unpredictably, just like unstable prices.	instability unpredictability fluctuation	stability steadiness constancy
03	**erratic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / डांवाडोल Not regular or consistent in pattern, movement, or behaviour.	Contains 'error' — an erratic pattern makes frequent errors in predictability.	unpredictable inconsistent fitful	consistent regular steady
04	**rendered** VERB NEUTRAL	बना दिया / कर दिया Caused someone or something to be in a particular state or condition.	Render sounds like 'surrender' — making someone or something into a particular state.	made caused to be turned	kept maintained preserved
05	**bounteous** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रचुर / भरपूर Generously given or existing in large, plentiful quantities.	Think of a 'bounty' or reward that is overflowing and plentiful.	plentiful abundant copious	meagre scarce sparse
06	**subsequently** ADVERB NEUTRAL	बाद में / तत्पश्चात At a later time or after a particular event has taken place.	Sequential means in order; 'sub-sequently' refers to the step that follows next.	afterwards later thereafter	previously prior beforehand
07	**manipulation** NOUN NEGATIVE	हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़ Unfair or fraudulent management and alteration of market conditions to one's advantage.	'Manipulate' comes from Latin 'manus' (hand) — artificially handling or tampering with outcomes.	rigging tampering exploitation	fairness honesty transparency
08	**dominant** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	प्रमुख / मुख्य Most important, influential, or prominent compared to others.	A dominant force dominates everything else because it is the most prominent.	primary principal predominant	minor secondary subordinate
09	**proactive** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय Controlling a situation by creating change rather than merely reacting after it happens.	'Pro' means forward — acting beforehand rather than simply reacting after damage occurs.	enterprising preventative forward-looking	reactive passive sluggish
10	**buffers** NOUN NEUTRAL	सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक Extra supplies of commodities kept in reserve to lessen the impact of future shortages.	A buffer cushion absorbs a shock; buffer stock protects against sudden supply shortages.	reserves cushions stockpiles	deficits shortages depletions
11	**highlighted** VERB NEUTRAL	उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी Drew particular attention to an issue or made something prominent.	Using a yellow highlighter pen to make text stand out clearly.	emphasised accentuated underlined	obscured downplayed masked
12	**commendably** ADVERB POSITIVE	सराहनीय रूप से In a manner that deserves praise, approval, or admiration.	Connect with 'commend' or 'recommend' — worthy of strong praise and approval.	laudably praiseworthily admirably	reprehensibly blameworthily poorly
13	**pitfalls** NOUN NEGATIVE	छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां Hidden or unsuspected dangers, difficulties, or traps in a plan.	A hidden pit into which you fall unexpectedly represents a hidden hazard.	hazards drawbacks perils	advantages safeguards benefits
14	**exhausted** VERB NEGATIVE	समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना Used up completely until nothing remains in reserve.	Like a car exhaust emitting until all fuel is completely drained out.	depleted drained spent	replenished restocked renewed

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · MANY LAYERS: ON ONION PRODUCE, ISSUES · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 2 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**procurement** NOUN NEUTRAL	खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति The official act of obtaining or buying goods and services, especially for public use.	To 'cure' a need for goods, an organisation goes through a pro-cure-ment process.	acquisition purchasing sourcing	disposal sale distribution
02	**hoarding** NOUN NEGATIVE	जमाखोरी The practice of collecting and storing large quantities of goods to create artificial scarcity.	A 'hoard' is an excessive secret pile kept hidden to drive prices up.	stockpiling accumulating cornering	distributing dispersing releasing

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 2 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**susceptible to** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील Likely to be influenced, harmed, or damaged by a particular factor.	Sounds like 'suspect able' — an entity easily suspected of catching harm.	vulnerable to prone to predisposed to	immune to resistant to invulnerable to
02	**persist with** VERB NEUTRAL	जारी रखना / लगे रहना To continue doing something or using a method despite difficulties or objections.	To persist is to stay 'per-manent' with a task despite obstacles.	continue with persevere in carry on with	abandon discontinue relinquish

PHRASAL VERBS · 3 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**alluded to** VERB NEUTRAL	का संकेत देना Referred to something indirectly or mentioned it in a passing manner.	Allude = A subtle clue; referring to something without naming it explicitly.	hinted at suggested implied	specified stated directly declared
02	**cool down** VERB NEUTRAL	शांत या स्थिर होना To decrease in intensity, speed, or price level after a period of inflation.	When heat drops, temperatures cool down; similarly, inflated prices moderate.	moderate subside abate	surge escalate heat up
03	**guard against** VERB POSITIVE	से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना To take precautions to stop a potential problem or danger from happening.	A security guard stands alert to prevent dangerous risks.	ward off shield from fend off	succumb to invite overlook

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 1 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**balancing-act** NOUN NEUTRAL	संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास A difficult situation where one tries to satisfy two opposing demands or priorities at the same time.	Picture a tightrope walker maintaining balance between two opposite sides.	compromise delicate balance tightrope walk	imbalance disproportion bias

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

THE INDIAN EXPRESS · JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

> *Selective relief for student protesters highlights lingering systemic bias against other democratic demonstrations.*

September 3, 2026 · 3 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

All the FIRs … are hereby **quashed**[1]." With that order by a three-judge bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, a welcome moment of closure was reached on Tuesday. The story began with the students' protests at Jantar Mantar against the NEET paper leak. It saw a **brutish**[2] **crackdown**[3] by the police on the march by mostly young protesters demanding a hearing from the people's representatives in Parliament. These columns have strongly and consistently argued for the freedom to protest peacefully, which is part of the constitutionally guaranteed right to free speech and expression, and against its **criminalisation**[4] by the government. And yet, **rewind to**[5] Tuesday's quashing of FIRs by the Court, **acting on**[6] the request of governments at the Centre and some states, and a question continues to hang in the courtroom: If Tuesday's quashing is an admission that a punishing state unfairly targeted citizens for exercising their democratic right to protest, isn't the manner of the quashing **problematic**[7] — because it seems **selective**[8]? The cases being closed is the right thing to do, but are they being closed for the right reason? Does the government find it **expedient**[9] to close them against one set of protesters while letting those against other protesters **linger on**[10], making the process their punishment? The question is, basically, this: What about the protesters **left out of**[11] Tuesday's frame?

Because the story of the April protests by factory workers in Noida demanding higher wages has **played out**[12] very differently. There, as this paper has reported, a police **crackdown**[3] saw up to 200 people **taken into custody**[13], including two under the **stringent**[14] NSA. The court **stepped in**[15] to grant relief in 84 per cent of the cases — on Wednesday, the Allahabad High Court **quashed**[1] the NSA detention of a student activist, terming the state's case "**concocted**[16]". But they fell one by one, for reasons ranging from lack of specific evidence to treating a crowd as the accused. There was no **blanket**[17] relief — the average period a protester spent in custody was 53 days. Cases related to the 2019-2020 protests against a **discriminatory**[18] citizenship law **unleashed**[19] prolonged legal battles across various courts. In UP, the government continued to harass the accused, **naming and shaming**[20] them in public hoardings, attaching properties by **undue**[21] process, ignoring the court's **rebuke**[22] that it had become both complainant and **adjudicator**[23]. Cases from the farmers' protests of 2021 are still pending. As are those slapped against individuals across the country, for the "crime" of disagreeing with the **powers that be**[24].

Tuesday's quashing of FIRs against students will be a valuable moment if it expands the area of freedom for all — if it means that **henceforth**[25], the government will be more tolerant of free speech and the Court will give the benefit of the doubt to the vulnerable individual, not the government. It will be unfortunate if it only means that the decision to file an FIR and the decision to quash a protest depends on whether the protester is seen as "us" or "them".

Source: The Indian Express · Published: September 03, 2026 06:00 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

No.	Word	Part of speech	Meaning
1	quashed	(Verb)	cancelled • रद्द कर दिया गया
2	brutish	(Adjective)	cruel • बर्बर
3	crackdown	(Noun)	suppression • सख्त कार्रवाई
4	criminalisation	(Noun)	outlawing • अपराधीकरण
5	rewind to	(Verb)	look back at • पीछे मुड़कर देखना
6	acting on	(Verb)	following • के अनुसार कार्य करना
7	problematic	(Adjective)	questionable • संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त
8	selective	(Adjective)	biased • चयनात्मक
9	expedient	(Adjective)	convenient • स्वार्थसाधक
10	linger on	(Verb)	persist • लंबे समय तक खिंचना
11	left out of	(Phrase)	excluded from • वंचित रखा गया
12	played out	(Verb)	unfolded • घटित हुआ
13	taken into custody	(Phrase)	arrested • हिरासत में लिया गया
14	stringent	(Adjective)	strict • कठोर
15	stepped in	(Verb)	intervened • हस्तक्षेप किया
16	concocted	(Adjective)	fabricated • मनगढ़ंत
17	blanket	(Adjective)	total • सार्वत्रिक
18	discriminatory	(Adjective)	unfair • भेदभावपूर्ण
19	unleashed	(Verb)	released • उन्मुक्त कर दिया
20	naming and shaming	(Phrase)	publicly humiliating • सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना
21	undue	(Adjective)	excessive • अनुचित
22	rebuke	(Noun)	scolding • फटकार
23	adjudicator	(Noun)	judge • निर्णायक
24	powers that be	(Phrase)	authorities • सत्तारूढ़ लोग
25	henceforth	(Adverb)	from now on • अब से

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

EDITORIAL STANCE
SCEPTICAL
"questioning government motives"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author critically examines the selective quashing of student FIRs, questioning whether the state's move stems from constitutional principles or political expediency. By contrasting this relief with the persistent penalisation of labour and citizenship protesters, the editorial highlights systemic disparities in how dissent is treated. It urges the judiciary and executive to uphold civil liberties uniformly rather than favouring convenient groups.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 14 WORDS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**quashed** VERB POSITIVE	रद्द कर दिया गया Officially annulled, rejected, or declared legally invalid by a court.	Sounds like 'squashed' — imagine a judge crushing or stamping out an unfair legal case.	annulled invalidated overturned	upheld validated enforced
02	**brutish** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बर्बर Savage, rough, and completely lacking human sensitivity or restraint.	Connect with 'brute' — acting like a wild, violent beast without reason or empathy.	barbaric ferocious callous	gentle humane compassionate
03	**crackdown** NOUN NEGATIVE	सख्त कार्रवाई Severe, sudden, and forceful disciplinary measures taken by authorities to restrict activity.	When authorities 'crack' the whip down on dissent to suppress it completely.	suppression repression clampdown	leniency indulgence tolerance
04	**problematic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त Presenting difficulties or doubts that make something open to serious question.	Root word 'problem' — something that directly generates doubts or difficulties.	contentious dubious questionable	unproblematic straightforward settled
05	**selective** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	चयनात्मक Affecting or choosing only certain individuals or groups, often unfairly or arbitrarily.	Relates to 'select' — choosing only what suits one's own advantage unfairly.	discriminating particular partial	universal indiscriminate uniform
06	**expedient** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	स्वार्थसाधक Convenient and practical for achieving an immediate end, though possibly improper or immoral.	Sounds like 'speedy end' — taking an easy shortcut even if it lacks ethical backing.	advantageous pragmatic opportunistic	principled inadvisable inexpedient
07	**stringent** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठोर Extremely strict, binding, or rigorously enforced, leaving little room for compromise.	Think of a 'strict string' pulled extremely tight with zero flexibility.	rigorous draconian uncompromising	lenient flexible lax
08	**concocted** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	मनगढ़ंत Invented, fabricated, or made up, usually with the intention to deceive.	Like a witch 'concocting' a fake potion in a cauldron—brewing a lie.	fabricated invented contrived	genuine authentic verified
09	**blanket** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सार्वत्रिक Applying to all conditions, instances, or people universally and without exception.	A 'blanket' spreads over everything, covering the whole bed without leaving gaps.	comprehensive all-inclusive sweeping	specific conditional targeted
10	**discriminatory** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	भेदभावपूर्ण Making an unfair, unjust, or prejudicial distinction against individuals or groups.	Root word 'discriminate' — showing prejudice against a specific group.	prejudicial biased inequitable	equitable impartial unbiased
11	**unleashed** VERB NEGATIVE	उन्मुक्त कर दिया Suddenly released or set loose a powerful, destructive, or uncontrollable force.	Un-leash: taking the leash off a wild dog, letting it run wild and cause chaos.	triggered vented precipitated	restrained contained suppressed
12	**undue** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनुचित Exceeding what is appropriate, warranted, or legally justified.	Un + due: not 'due' or appropriate according to standard legal rules.	unwarranted excessive disproportionate	due justified warranted
13	**rebuke** NOUN NEGATIVE	फटकार A sharp, stern expression of disapproval or severe criticism.	Sounds like 'refuse back' — strongly rejecting someone's behaviour with harsh words.	reprimand reproach censure	commendation praise endorsement
14	**henceforth** ADVERB NEUTRAL	अब से From this specific point in time onward.	Hence (from here) + forth (forward in time) = from this moment onwards.	hereafter from now on subsequently	previously formerly hitherto

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · THANK YOU FOR QUASHING THE FIRS, BUT THERE'S A QUESTION · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 2 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**criminalisation** NOUN NEGATIVE	अपराधीकरण The act of turning an ordinary or lawful activity into an illegal offence punishable by law.	Turning regular citizens or lawful actions into 'criminals' by making laws against them.	proscription outlawing penalisation	decriminalisation legalisation legitimisation
02	**adjudicator** NOUN NEUTRAL	निर्णायक A person or body that formally reviews evidence to settle a legal or official dispute.	Ad-JUDGE-icator: someone whose formal role is to 'judge' a legal dispute.	arbitrator judge umpire	complainant litigant accused

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 1 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**acting on** VERB NEUTRAL	के अनुसार कार्य करना Taking decisive action in accordance with specific advice, requests, or information received.	You 'act on' instructions when you step forward based on advice or orders.	executing implementing discharging	disregarding ignoring overlooking

PHRASAL VERBS · 4 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**rewind to** VERB NEUTRAL	पीछे मुड़कर देखना To look back at or return mentally to an earlier event or point in time.	Like 'rewinding' a video tape to revisit a previous scene in the past.	revisit recall reconsider	fast-forward to advance to project
02	**linger on** VERB NEGATIVE	लंबे समय तक खिंचना To continue to exist or take an unusually long time to finish or disappear.	Think of someone who 'lingers' behind after a party, refusing to leave for too long.	persist drag on continue	conclude vanish terminate
03	**played out** VERB NEUTRAL	घटित हुआ Developed, unfolded, or occurred in a particular manner over time.	Like a theatrical 'play' that performs its script sequentially from start to finish.	transpired unfolded materialised	halted stalled aborted
04	**stepped in** VERB POSITIVE	हस्तक्षेप किया Intervened in a difficult or contentious situation to provide assistance or resolve a conflict.	Literally 'stepping' into the middle of a conflict to restore order.	intervened mediated interceded	abstained withdrew neglected

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 4 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**left out of** PHRASE NEGATIVE	वंचित रखा गया Excluded, omitted, or ignored from a particular group, decision, or benefit.	Left standing outside the 'frame' or boundary while others are included inside.	omitted from excluded from marginalised from	included in integrated into admitted to
02	**taken into custody** PHRASE NEGATIVE	हिरासत में लिया गया Formally detained or arrested by law enforcement officers.	When authorities take 'custody' (care/control) of a person's freedom by detaining them.	detained apprehended imprisoned	released liberated discharged
03	**naming and shaming** PHRASE NEGATIVE	सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना Publicly identifying individuals or organisations accused of wrongdoing to cause humiliation.	Rhyming phrase: 'name' them openly so that everyone can 'shame' them.	publicising offences discrediting pillorying	protecting anonymity shielding pardoning
04	**powers that be** PHRASE NEUTRAL	सत्तारूढ़ लोग The established authorities, rulers, or decision-makers holding institutional control.	Those who possess the executive 'power' that currently 'exists' (is).	establishment authorities rulers	subordinates general public powerless

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

THE INDIAN EXPRESS · INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTES & ENVIRONMENTAL GOVERNANCE

Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

> *Riparian states must shun confrontation and forge a scientific distress-sharing formula for Cauvery waters.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read · DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The opening of the Mettur Dam's **sluice gates**[1] by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday will provide some relief to Cauvery Delta farmers. In a normal year, the dam opens on June 12, and its gates are shut on January 28, giving the region's agriculturists a 230-day irrigation window. This schedule is, however, **contingent on**[2] the monsoon and the release of water in the Cauvery's upstream by Karnataka. The Tamil Nadu government has **ascribed**[3] this year's delay to the deficit in the southwest monsoon and Karnataka's failure to honour its water-sharing obligation under the Supreme Court's 2018 verdict. The dispute between the lower and upper **riparian**[4] states **ignited**[5] political tensions in the past three months, and the matter went to the Supreme Court, but the **impasse**[6] wasn't resolved. With the rainfall deficit narrowing in August, the Tamil Nadu government has **leeway**[7] to release water for 45 days.

The Cauvery Management Authority, set up to **oversee**[8] the implementation of the 2018 verdict, has worked during normal monsoon years. But the Court did not **codify**[9] a formula for water-sharing in years when the rains **play truant**[10]. Its emphasis on **sustainable**[11] water use was **lost on**[12] the two states, and the dispute **flared up**[13] again in 2023 — the first **below-par**[14] monsoon after 2018.

The Tamil Nadu government has said that it will continue legal efforts to secure its share of the Cauvery's waters. Karnataka's push for the Mekedatu Dam on the river has **reignited**[15] old fears . The D K Shivakumar government's argument that the dam would primarily serve Bengaluru's water needs while allowing better regulation of releases hasn't **found any takers**[16] in Tamil Nadu. The fact is, the Cauvery today has to meet the **competing demands**[17] of agriculture and urbanisation. Therefore, rather than **lean on**[18] the judiciary, Cauvery-dependent states **would do well to**[19] come together and plan for the efficient use of the river's waters. Solutions ranging from **disincentivising**[20] water-intensive crops to encouraging **decentralised**[21] water management will require inputs of hydrologists, economists, agri-scientists and farmers' organisations. Representatives of the two states will need to sit together, understand each other's fears and **shed**[22] **confrontationist**[23] attitudes.

Source: The Indian Express · Published: September 03, 2026 06:00 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

No.	Word	Part of speech	Meaning
1	Sluice gates	(Noun phrase)	Water-control gates • जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक
2	Contingent on	(Adjective + preposition)	Dependent on • पर निर्भर
3	Ascribed	(Verb)	Attributed • कारण ठहराया
4	Riparian	(Adjective)	Riverbank-related • तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय
5	Ignited	(Verb)	Triggered • भड़काया
6	Impasse	(Noun)	Deadlock • गतिरोध
7	Leeway	(Noun)	Flexibility • कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील
8	Oversee	(Verb)	Supervise • निगरानी करना
9	Codify	(Verb)	Systematise • संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना
10	Play truant	(Idiom)	Stay absent • अनुपस्थित रहना / धोखा देना
11	Sustainable	(Adjective)	Maintainable • सतत / टिकाऊ
12	Lost on	(Phrasal adjective)	Unappreciated by • अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना
13	Flared up	(Phrasal verb)	Erupted • अचानक भड़क उठा
14	Below-par	(Adjective phrase)	Below average • औसत से कम
15	Reignited	(Verb)	Revived • पुनः भड़काया
16	Found any takers	(Idiom)	Gained acceptance • स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना
17	Competing demands	(Noun phrase)	Conflicting needs • परस्पर विरोधी माँगें
18	Lean on	(Phrasal verb)	Depend upon • सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना
19	Would do well to	(Idiom)	Ought to • अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें
20	Disincentivising	(Verb (gerund))	Discouraging • हतोत्साहित करना
21	Decentralised	(Adjective)	Locally managed • विकेंद्रीकृत
22	Shed	(Verb)	Discard • त्यागना / छोड़ना
23	Confrontationist	(Adjective)	Aggressive • टकरावपूर्ण / संघर्षशील

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTES & ENVIRONMENTAL GOVERNANCE

EDITORIAL STANCE
PERSUASIVE / ADVOCATIVE
"urging cooperative policy action"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author examines the recurring water-sharing dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka during deficit monsoon seasons, pointing out that judicial decrees cannot substitute for institutional distress-sharing mechanisms. Highlighting the limitations of ad hoc legal battles, the editorial advocates for technical collaboration, crop diversification, and dialogue to balance agricultural and urban water requirements.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 10 WORDS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Ascribed** VERB NEUTRAL	कारण ठहराया Regarded something as being caused by a specific factor or origin.	A-SCRIBE means writing down a cause to explain an effect.	attributed assigned credited	disassociated disconnected severed
02	**Ignited** VERB NEGATIVE	भड़काया Provoked or sparked sudden and intense feelings, conflict, or controversy.	IGNITE means lighting a match, metaphorically sparking an explosive dispute.	sparked triggered instigated	extinguished quelled dampened
03	**Leeway** NOUN POSITIVE	कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील The amount of freedom to move or act that is available in a given situation.	LEEWAY gives you 'way' or space to take action comfortably.	latitude flexibility discretion	constraint restriction rigidity
04	**Oversee** VERB NEUTRAL	निगरानी करना To supervise a person or an entire process to ensure correct execution.	OVER-SEE: Seeing something from above to ensure it is done correctly.	supervise monitor scrutinise	neglect ignore overlook
05	**Codify** VERB NEUTRAL	संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना To arrange laws, rules, or guidelines into a systematic, official code.	CODIFY = Arrange into a systematic CODE of laws.	systematise formulate standardise	disorganise scramble randomise
06	**Sustainable** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सतत / टिकाऊ Able to be maintained at a certain rate or level without exhausting natural resources.	SUSTAIN + ABLE = Able to be maintained long-term without depletion.	viable enduring renewable	unsustainable depleting short-lived
07	**Reignited** VERB NEGATIVE	पुनः भड़काया Revived or renewed feelings of anger, conflict, or controversy.	RE (again) + IGNITE (spark fire); reviving an old conflict.	rekindled reawakened resuscitated	extinguished pacified suppressed
08	**Disincentivising** VERB (GERUND) NEUTRAL	हतोत्साहित करना Discouraging a particular action by removing advantages or imposing deterrents.	DIS + INCENTIVE = Removing incentives to discourage unwanted behavior.	discouraging deterring dissuading	incentivising encouraging promoting
09	**Decentralised** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	विकेंद्रीकृत Controlled by several local offices or authorities rather than one single central authority.	DE + CENTRAL = Moving power away from a single central authority to local units.	devolutionary localised dispersed	centralised consolidated concentrated
10	**Shed** VERB POSITIVE	त्यागना / छोड़ना To get rid of something no longer wanted, useful, or appropriate.	Snakes shed their old skin; similarly, shedding old hostile attitudes.	discard relinquish abandon	retain acquire maintain

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · CAUVERY NEEDS A DISTRESS-SHARING COMPACT · PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 3 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Riparian** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय Relating to or situated on the banks of a river or natural body of water.	RIPARIAN relates to RIVER; states located along a river's course.	riverside riverbank fluvial	inland landlocked arid
02	**Impasse** NOUN NEGATIVE	गतिरोध A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of disagreement.	IM-PASSE = Impossible to pass further due to complete disagreement.	deadlock stalemate standstill	breakthrough resolution headway
03	**Confrontationist** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	टकरावपूर्ण / संघर्षशील Tending to cause or engage in aggressive and hostile arguments or conflict.	CONFRONT = Head-on clash; one who prefers hostile confrontation over talks.	belligerent antagonistic combative	conciliatory peaceable accommodating

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 1 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Contingent on** ADJECTIVE + PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	पर निर्भर Dependent on or conditioned by future uncertain circumstances.	CONTINGENT sounds like 'continual agent' whose action depends on another condition.	conditional upon dependent on subject to	independent of unconditional autonomous

PHRASAL VERBS · 2 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Flared up** PHRASAL VERB NEGATIVE	अचानक भड़क उठा Began suddenly or increased in violence or intensity.	A flare suddenly bursts into bright fire; a dormant issue suddenly re-erupts.	erupted reignited resurged	subsided abated died down
02	**Lean on** PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना To depend on someone or an institution heavily for help, support, or decisions.	Physically leaning on a wall to stay upright, meaning depending on support.	rely upon count on depend upon	act independently shun disregard

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 7 TERMS

No.	Word	Meaning	Memory hook	Synonyms	Antonyms
01	**Sluice gates** NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक Sliding gates used for controlling the flow of water in a dam, reservoir, or canal.	SLUICE sounds like 'SLIDE'; gates that slide up and down to regulate water flow.	floodgates headgates watergates	barriers blockades obstructions
02	**Play truant** IDIOM NEGATIVE	अनुपस्थित रहना / धोखा देना To stay away from where one is expected to be; used here to denote failure of rainfall.	A truant child skips school without permission; here, rains fail to arrive.	be missing default fail to appear	show up be present arrive
03	**Lost on** PHRASAL ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना Failing to influence, impress, or be understood by someone.	The message was LOST and never reached the recipient's understanding.	ignored by unheeded by unnoticed by	appreciated by understood by grasped by
04	**Below-par** ADJECTIVE PHRASE NEGATIVE	औसत से कम Below the usual, expected, or standard level or quality.	In golf, 'par' is standard; 'below-par' performance or rainfall is worse than standard.	substandard deficient mediocre	above-par exceptional superior
05	**Found any takers** IDIOM NEGATIVE	स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना Found people willing to accept, purchase, or agree to an offer or argument.	Nobody is willing to 'take' or buy into the proposal.	gained acceptance found buyers won support	faced rejection met refusal been dismissed
06	**Competing demands** NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	परस्पर विरोधी माँगें Multiple claims or requirements that cannot all be satisfied simultaneously.	Two separate entities competing for the very same limited resource.	conflicting claims rival interests opposing needs	harmonious needs aligned interests mutual goals
07	**Would do well to** IDIOM POSITIVE	अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें Used to give advice or suggest that a course of action is sensible and beneficial.	A polite phrase used by advisers meaning 'it is strongly recommended'.	ought to should consider are advised to	would regret should avoid are ill-advised to

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TODAY'S EDITORIALS
ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

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